SIS 05
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Teambuilding Games

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Name Games

Name

Stand/sit in a circle. The first person says his/her name. Then the person next to the first says his/her name and also says the first person's name again, and so on all the way around the circle. The last person has to repeat everyone's name.

Names and action

Make a standing circle. Have one person start by saying his/her name and an action. The action should start with the same letter of the name (Energetic Eric, Jumping Josephine). They tell the name and perform the action: so "Jumping Josephine" would jump up and down. Each one say his/her name and action and each subsequent person repeats the action and name of the people before and add his/her on. The last person has to repeat everything.

Name and adjective

Everyone gives an adjective before their name. The adjective the delegate chooses should start with the same letter with which their first names begin. It can be random or describing the person. For example: *Catastrophic Christopher, Daring Daniel, Petrified Peter, or Rockin' Robin.*

Name and ball

Stand in a circle. A small ball is thrown around the circle. The person holding the ball says the name of the person he/she is throwing the ball to. Go around the circle at least once, so everyone can say his/her name.

Name and personal fact

Sit in a circle. The first person says his/her name and a one personal fact (favourite food, earliest memory, address, etc.) The second person repeats the first delegate's name and fact and adds his/her own ones and so on. The last person has to repeat everyone's name. Delegates then change places within the circle and one volunteer attempts to give the names and sentences for everyone in this new order.

Name and sign

The group stands in a circle. First person has to say his/her name and do a sign. Next person has to repeat the name and sign of the first person and then say his/her own name and do the sign. Last person has to repeat everything. (You can do the same with noises).

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Warm Ups

Ball in group

The ball has to touch everyone in the committee in the shortest possible time.

Equipment: A ball and a stop-watch.

Interview

The group is split up into pairs. The pairs now have time to talk to each other. Later they present their partner to the group. They could also state three facts, of which one is a lie. The group has to work out which was the lie.

Two truths and a lie

Each person has to tell two truths about him/herself and one lie, while the others try to guess which is the lie. The key is to make the truths as outrageous as the lies so they are believable.

Variation:
Each delegate is asked three questions by the rest of the committee. Two questions must be answered truthfully, and one response must be a lie.

Map of Europe

Members of the group should form an imaginary map of Europe on the ground and take a stand at the position of their country. This shows them the diversity of their committee.

Catch it

The group stands in a circle. Someone takes the ball, throws it in the air and calls out someone's name. This person has to run and catch the ball and so on.

Equipment: A ball.

Ball in order

The committee stands in a circle. The committee is told that they now have to throw a ball around the circle (starting with the chair) and every member must have had the ball once before it goes back to the chair. After the first round they have to throw the SAME combination again. Then as quick as possible. And quicker... (They can manage in 2 seconds!)

Equipment: A ball.

Order!

All members stand next to each other in a line. They then have to line up in order, according to their age, their height or the first letter of their name. This game gets more difficult with no talking being allowed and only sign language being used.

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Icebreakers / Energisers

Blind Animal Game

Everyone is blindfolded and gets down on hands and knees. Each person is given the name of an animal and has to perform the distinctive sound (like a pig, horse, lion, snake etc) Names should be assigned in pairs, so that there are two of every animal. The goal is then for each "animal" to find its pair!

Blip Blop

Everybody stands in a circle. A pen (or an other small object) is passed from hand to hand in this way:

- This is a Blip
- A what?
- That is a Blip.

The person who receives it, passes it on by saying the same, but it is only the first person who knows what is really is so it is always going back to the first person. At the same time another pen is passed on the other way, this pen is called Blop. Every body needs to be quite aware and awake.

Equipment: A small object (e.g. a pen).

Buzzing Bees

All the delegates are blindfolded and are walking in a rectangular plane saying an "mmm" sound. The facilitator knocks on one delegate who is then allowed to open his or her eyes and stop saying "mmm". The other delegates' task is to find the quiet, sighted person. The ones who find the group of sighted people also become quiet and is allowed to take off the blindfolded. They are not allowed to talk until everyone in the group has found his/her way to them.

Equipment: Blindfolds.

Cat and Mouse

Form pairs. Each of the pairs links arms. Choose a pair who will start the game. Choose one to be the cat, and give him or her the ball. The other is the mouse. The cat attempts to catch the mouse and tag it with the ball. If the cat succeeds, the ball changes hands: the mouse becomes the cat and vice versa. The mouse can become safe by linking arms with any one of the pairs. The member of the pair that did not get linked to then becomes the mouse and is forced to unlink. That person, of course, can link to another pair. Play this game when everyone is too wild. It's pretty tiring.

Equipment: A ball.

Copy Cat

The committee is formed into a circle, and one delegate is asked to volunteer to be the "guesser". The guesser goes out of the circle and walks about 10–15 metres away (or goes behind a wall or tree if available.) The guesser then closes his or her eyes. The idea is for the guesser to be unable to see what the rest of the circle is doing or to hear what they are saying. Among the rest of the circle, a delegate volunteers or is chosen to lead the group. The leader then begins making a motion and everyone else copies it. They do so, using any part of their entire body. Someone then yell to the guesser that the group is ready. The guesser comes back and stands in the middle of the circle. The object is for the guesser to guess who the leader is. The leader can change the motion, and everyone else follows. It works best if not everyone looks at the leader. The guesser gets three guesses to guess who the leader is. If he/she guesses correctly, the person who started the motion is the one who is removed from the space for the next round.
After a third incorrect guess, the leader reveals him or her.

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Do This, Do That !

This is played in the same way as Simon Says except that the leader proceeds his or her orders with either "Do this" or "Do that". If the command is "Do this", then all the players should copy his or her actions. If it is "Do that", then they should remain still.

Fill The Gap

The players except for one stand in a large circle. One player walks around the circle and touches a player on the shoulder. Then both of these players must run around the circle in the opposite direction in order to reach the gap in the circle. He/she must then walk around the outside of the circle and touch someone else.

Fruit Salad

The delegates sit on chairs in a circle. There should be one chair less than there are delegates. Each delegate is named by a fruit e.g. banana, apple, pear, orange.
One of the delegates stands in the middle of the circle and says the name of the fruit e.g. if he says apple, all the apples must change seats. The delegate in the middle can now sit again if he finds a free seat. The delegate who is left without a seat must now go into the middle and the game begins again. If the delegate in the middle says "Fruit Salad", all members must change seat.

Equipment: chairs.

Giants, Wizards and Dwarfs

This is a team approach to the ancient game of rock, paper, and scissors.

The key to the game is this:
Wizards cast spells on giants. Giants squish dwarfs. Dwarfs are small and quick and outsmart wizards.
The game begins with teams huddling together, deciding which creatures the team will be. The entire team must be the same creature at the same time. As soon as the teams have decided on their creature, they line up face to face with the opposing team, in rows about four feet apart. On the leader's command team members jump to their pose. A point is scored on the basis of which creature beats which. If both teams form the same creature, no point is scored and teams return to their huddle to decide their next team move. The first team to score 5-7 points wins.

Gordian Knot

The group stands in a circle with everyone facing the middle. Everyone puts their hands in the middle, one open hand and one fist. Everyone must then grab with his/her hand one fist. The knot must then be unravelled, without letting go of the hands. At the end there is usually one circle, but sometimes there will be two.

Variations:
Different variations on this exercise include appointing one delegate as the spokesperson, and requiring all others remain silent. Or to appoint one delegate as the spokesperson, and have all other delegates close their eyes and work only by feel and listening to the spokesperson verbal directions.

Pass the giggle

The committee lies on the ground in a way so that every member has his/ her head on the stomach of another person. Only the head of the first person of the line lies on the ground. The first person starts to "pass the giggle" and the next person has to pass it on. Then it starts again with a new giggle.

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Pass the Pulse

Everybody intertwines their arms and holds hands with their eyes closed. The facilitator is the generator of the "pulse". The facilitator starts with passing the "pulse" by squeezing the hand of the person to their right or left. The person who just received the pulse then squeezes the other hand he/she is holding, and the process continues on throughout the group. The pulse should travel around the circle a couple of times, with the facilitator passing it just like everyone else. When this pulse is travelling, you can send a new pulse. Then game ends when the facilitator progressively stop all of the pulses.

Simon Says

One player is chosen as the leader, and the others stand around the room in front of him or her. The leader then gives commands that the others should either follow or ignore, depending on how the command is given. If the leader begins the command with "Simon says", then everyone should carry out his or her command. For example, if he/she says, "Simon says touch your toes", then the others should bend over and touch their toes. If, however, the leader just says, "Touch your toes", then the order should be ignored. If someone follows an order that did not have "Simon says" before it, then he/she is eliminated.
The leader can also mislead the other players by giving out the orders very fast, by carrying out him/her commands that were not preceded by "Simon Says", or by creating a rhythm of orders in a pattern that is then suddenly broken by a wrong command. The last player to be caught out is the winner and takes the place of the leader.

Skin the Snake

All delegates line up one behind another. Each delegate puts their right hand forward as if they were shaking hands. Put left hand through own legs behind to shake hands with person behind you.
Without breaking the chain, start the game. The last person in the line lies down on their back. Everyone else backs up to be able to lie down also. When whole group is lying down, first person stands up, and walks forward over all the other people until the "snake" has skinned itself. Be careful not to step on them!

There Ain't No Flies On Me

The group should be divided in two parts and placed on each short side of a rectangular plane. The first group starts and takes one step towards the centre of the plane, saying "There ain't no flies on me". They take another two steps and finish the third step by saying "But there are some flies on you". The other group does the same. When they have taken their third step and the two groups are facing each other – the first group says "Kaboom". The task is now for each group to bring the other group's members to their side. Once brought to the other side you become a member of the new group. Only one team will win.

Viking

All of the players sit in a circle. One person starts as the Viking by putting their fingers at their side of their head like horns on their hat. This Viking passes the role of being a Viking by pointing their horns at someone. If you are pointed at, you become a Viking (horns and all) and the person on the right has to start paddling to the right and the person on the left has to start paddling on the left. The last person of the threesome to assume their position is out. The rest of the players slap their legs during the game in a constant rhythm.

Zip Zap Zop

Someone begins by pointing the player to his/her side and says 'zip'. That player turns to the next player in the circle, points to them and says 'zip'. Thus the 'zip' zips around the circle in one direction. At any time a receiving player can say 'zap' to the person pointing at them. When they do the player that said 'zip' and was pointing at them must change direction of the pointing. This means that they must quickly turn around, point and say 'zip' to the person that just pointed at them. Now the 'zip' can zip around the circle, but changing direction every time there is a 'zap'. Lastly the person that receives the 'zip' may elect to yell 'zop' and point at someone anywhere in the circle. That player then restarts the 'zip' going in the direction of their choice.

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One foot in the circle

The Chair forms a small circle with a rope on the ground. You are allowed to stand on one foot only and the task is for everybody to stand in the circle.

Equipment: A rope.

Ball goes on holiday

The group stands in a close circle. A tennis ball has to be squeezed between chin and neck. The group has to transport the ball once around the circle with no hands being used.

Equipment: A ball.

Sympathy gram

The committee sits or stands in a circle. One person steps into the middle and tells something he/she likes. Everyone who agrees steps into the circle. Then there is another round with things you do not like.

Prisoner

The group stands in a tight circle, everyone putting their arms on the shoulders of their neighbours. One person is in the middle and has to try to get out, with the others preventing them from doing so.

Stand up

The group splits up into pairs. They sit on the ground, back to back with arms linked and try to stand up. Once all the pairs have managed to do this, they try to do the same thing in groups of four, and then finally with the whole group.

Over and under

The group forms a line. 20 objects are put in front of the feet of the first person who must pass them one by one to their neighbour behind them. However it is only allowed to pass the objects over their head. Once the object reaches the last person in the row it must be passed back to the front, this time being passed through the legs.

Snake

The group forms a line, legs spread. They put their right hand between their legs and grab the hand of the person in front of them with their left hand. The last in the row now lays on the ground, and the group starts moving slowly backwards above him/her. Whenever a member of the group passes the last person lying, they lay down as well.

Machine

One person starts being one part of an imaginary machine. One after the other has to join the machine and represent a different part of this machine.

Get the tail

Split the group into two teams, or play this game with another committee. All members of each team form a line by holding hands. The first one is the head, the last one has the tail, a blindfold hanging at his/her back. The teams have to get the other's tail by running around and defending their own. The winner is the team that gets the other tail first.

Variation: all members have a tail. The winner is the one who gets more tails.

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Suck and Blow

Stand/sit in a circle, arrange boy, girl, boy.... The first person places the card on his/her lips, then using nothing but air pressure passes it to the person sitting next to him. This person takes the card by sucking it and passes it to the next person, never touching the card with hands. If the card is dropped during the exchange it has to be repeated again.

Equipment: A good-sized index card or sheet of paper.

Songs

Zulu Dance

If you look at me a zulu you can see
If you dance with me a zulu you can be
Hey - Zulu - Attention - ...

1. [...] – right hand
2. [...] – right hand - left hand
3. [...] – right hand - left hand - right foot
4. [...] – right hand - left hand - right foot - left foot
5. [...] – right hand - left hand - right foot - left foot - down
6. [...] – right hand - left hand - right foot - left foot - down – around

Funky chicken

Let me see your funky chicken!!
What did you say?
I say, let me see your funky chicken!!
What did you say?
I said: Uh – ah – ah – ah (3 times)
One more time
Uh – ah – ah – ah (3 times)
Back in line!

Replace the funky chicken with other characters (i.e. Britney Spears, Madonna, Magic Johnson...)

Frog song

Um – ha said a little green frog one day
Um – ha said a little green frog! (2 times)
BUT
We know frogs go
Sha – la – la – la – la (3 times)
We know frogs go
Sha – la – la – la – la (3 times)

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Trust/Blind Block

Drunken Bottle
The group stands in a narrow circle, hands towards the centre of the circle. One person stands in the middle: he/she should point his/her feet on to the ground, protect his/her chest and close his/her eyes. The group start slowly passing them around the circle.

Fall in the arms
The group splits up into pairs. One of the two must let themselves fall backwards into the arms of the others.

Human Corridor
The group forms two lines, standing face to face. They each put out one arm so that their hands are almost at the same level. One member of the group runs now from a five metres distance into this corridor and the other group members have to lift up their arms at the very last moment to let this person pass.

Walking nightline
Everyone puts on their blindfold. They form a row, and are given a rope in their hands. One person is allowed to see and must now lead the group over a certain distance. Care should be taken to ensure that no one is injured.

Blind guidance
The group splits up into pairs. One of the two put on a blindfold, the other person is leading. After a while, they change roles. The blind person can also be lead without words and without being touched.

The humming game
Each member is blind folded and hums while walking around a defined area. The chair tips on the shoulder of one person who then takes off his/ her blind fold, stands still and stops humming. The others have to find this person who does not hum and then stand beside him/her. Everyone must hum as long as they do not find the silent person.

Killer Car
The group split into pairs, holding the arm of the other. One pair is the killer car and must chase the other pairs. If another pair is tagged they become the chasers. If the pair is separated they are not allowed to tag anyone until they join up again.

Variation:
Blindfold half of the committee and have their pair to give them orders where to go.

Animal Farm
Every person is blindfolded. Everyone has to choose an animal he/she wants to be and start doing the noise of this particular animal. Then the chair asks the committee to find each other according to specific criteria. (e.g. size, animals that fly, pets, ...) Delegates may only communicate in the noises of the animals.

Blind search
Pick out approximately 5 objects that the group members can look at/touch. Send them out of the room and blindfold them. When they come back in the objects are hidden in the room and the group has to work together to find them. They have 5 minutes. Define a quite small area where you hide the objects.

Equipment: Approximately 5 objects. Blindfolds for the whole group.

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From Communication to Problem Solving

Following Directions

Form pairs. Give each person a piece of paper. The partner sit back to back, such that one person cannot see the hands and paper of the other person. One person is designated the creator. By tearing and folding, s/he creates a shape/structure out of his paper. As s/he does this, s/he tells his/her partner how to create the shape. The person following directions is not allowed to ask questions. After a few minutes, the pairs face each other and compare completed shapes. Then, roles are switched. This time, the person following directions is allowed to ask questions. Afterwards, discuss how the experiences differed, and how communication is important.

Equipment: A piece of paper, pens or pencils.

Story Telling

Three persons go out into the hall or in some other way isolated from the group. A story is told to the group. No notes are allowed. The story should be about two to three minutes in length, and contain many details. Then, one of the isolated people is called in. A group member repeats the story as s/he remembers it to the isolated person. Then another isolated person is called in. The first isolated person tells the story to the second. The pattern repeats until all the isolated people have heard the story. During this time, the audience is not to make any comments about the story. After everyone has heard the story, the audience is allowed to comment on the version told by the last person. After all comments have been made, the original story is read again.

Telephone Game

Everyone line up in a row, usually against a wall. At one end, a message is whispered into the first person's ear such that no other person can hear what is said. The message is passed from person to person, until the last person gets it. This person announces to the group the message s/he received. The originating person also announces the original message. During message passing, no repeating of the message is allowed. The final message is often quite different from the original.

Caterpillar

The delegates are lined up. You tie their ankles together. They can't move unless they make a rhythm. They all have to work together. Set a goal for them, for example walking for 10 metres from the start.

Equipment: Ropes.

River Game

Divide the committee in two groups. There is a river between the two groups of about 50 centimetres in the beginning. The group which starts is to transport a small object (e.g. a ball) to the group on the other side of the river without throwing it. Each time one of the groups succeeds to transport the object, the gap between them is increased. The group is to co-operate when the gap is getting bigger and bigger in order to get the object handed over to the other group.

Equipment: A small object, e.g. a ball.

Silent Killer

The delegates are given a space with in which to move. They are told to feel the space, and move freely. They are then instructed to close their eyes, and to continue to move throughout the space. Here is where the killer is chosen. The facilitator should tap one of the delegates on the head, signifying that they are the killer. This is done silently. The killer, still with their eyes closed, is required to move around the space and find their victims.
The only person who should be attempting to touch anyone else is the killer. When they find a victim, the killer grabs that victim on the shoulder, arm, etc. The victim then dies with a melodramatic final scream (giving a clue to the other potential victims where the killer is, or at least was). The game can be moved along by using the victims who are already dead to close in a tighter space, tightening up the circle in which the delegates are moving.

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…ano Game

…lace the container, half-filled, in the centre of a circle which is about 10 feet in diameter. The goal is to get the container out of the circle. The circle is filled with "lava". No one can touch it. Anyone who touches it is dead and cannot help the cause.

Equipment: For this game, you need a lightweight, open container capable of holding about 2 quarts water, and some rope that is at least 1/4" thick, about 30 feet or more. You also need some way of marking the circle.

Blind Square

Everyone puts on their blindfolds. A rope is put on the ground with each group member being led to a certain point of the rope and being told to touch it. When everyone is in position, they are told to form a perfect square.
(When they fail for a long time to do so, one group member can be allowed to let go of the rope and find out the positions of the others by walking along the rope.)

Equipment: A large rope tied in a circle and blindfolds.

IKEA Game (also called "Replication")

The organisers of the game begin by finding multiples of objects. You should have at least 8 different objects (sweatshirts, jackets, cell phones, pens, glasses etc). Then, where none of the participants can see, arrange one set of the objects. Maybe place the pen horizontally in the middle of the binder open to page 4 and put the pinecone centred above the binder.
Then gather the delegates and split them into three groups and explain the game. Each group has 2 builders, 1 or 2 runners, and 1 looker. The looker gets to see the original model.
The builders get a pile of the same objects in a separate room from the other builders, or at least where they can't see or hear the other groups. The runners are spaced between. The interaction goes like this: The lookers look at the original and go half or a third of the way towards the rooms with the builders and meets the runner. This spot must be the same distance for each group. The looker tells the runner all of the details he can remember about the model. Then the runner goes to the builders.
When the runner gets to the builders, the builders can only ask the runner yes or no questions. "Does the pen go here? Is the binder open? Is it open to this page? To this page?" As a facilitator you make sure the runner only says yes or no. When the runner can't remember anymore details or wants to confirm a detail, they go back to the point where they can meet the looker. They can converse freely about the details. This back and forth goes on until all of the groups feel they are done or are pretty much done. Then everyone gets together and looks at each groups finished model. Then everyone can go and look at the original.

Equipment: As above.

Magic Stick

The group splits into two and stands in two lines face to face, putting out both arms so that they touch the person opposite them with the fingertips only. The stick is put on their fingertips and must be lowered slowly to the ground.

Variation:
Let everyone but one delegate be blindfolded.

Equipment: A long stick.

Multilegged Monster

The aim of this task is to transport your group over a distance of 20 meters while singing a song.
Constraints: Only a set of legs may touch the ground at any one time:

Group of 12: 8 Legs
Group of 13: 9 Legs
Group of 14: 10 Legs …

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If more than the stated number of legs touches the ground the group must return to the start and try again.
A leg is defined as any part of the human anatomy that is touching the ground.
Head and tail must be apparent.

Built it!

Prepare an image or build an object composed by different elements (leaves, stones, pens...). Each delegate can see the original object once at time, and then they have to build it.

Murder Mystery

The players sit in a circle facing inwards. One player, the detective is taken away where he can not see or hear the others. One of the players in the circle is designated as the murderer. The players are told a secret signal (e.g. a hand signal). The detective is then returned to the circle where he must guess the identity of the murderer before he kills everyone. If any of the players notes the signal coming from the murderer he must 'die' in some dramatic fashion. The detective only has a limited number of guesses in which to guess the identity of the murderer (by pointing at them). If the detective fails to guess in time, the murderer takes his place and play continues anew. 3 guesses is a sensible number for most groups.

Murder Game

This game has two rounds. The committee sits in a circle with eyes closed. The chair tells the group that he will now select a murderer by tipping this very person on the shoulder. But the chair is not tipping anyone on the shoulder! They now have to look around in the circle and observe each member for 2 minutes in order to decide according to the behaviour of each member who they want to accuse being the murderer. They are not allowed to talk. After two minutes they have to point at the person who they think is the murderer. Then they have to close their eyes again. This time the chair tips everyone on the shoulder. Then same procedure.
Ask the members how different they have felt in both rounds and what they have observed.

Plane Wreck Game

Your committee is presented with this scenario: the people in the group were on a plan when it crashed in the desert. The plane is on fire and will soon explode. They must determine which five items they will retrieve from the plane to help them survive in the desert.
The items available are:

- life vest
- 2-way radio
- picture of Chairman Mao
- crate of army rations
- book of matches
- flashlight with batteries
- case of three emergency flares
- mirror
- map of surrounding area
- sextant
- compass
- water purification tablets

The individuals are to choose the five items that they wish to save. At this point they are not to discuss their choices with the other group members. Then, give five minutes to talk as a group to reach consensus. After the second period, the place explodes.
Talk about how choices were made. Was voting necessary? Did everyone agree at the beginning? How were tough decisions made? Did any compromising take place?

Equipment: A sheet with the items to choose between.

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Spider Web

Every group member has to get from one side to the other, by only using each hole in the web once. They are not at all allowed to touch the web.

Equipment: Lengths of strong rope, two poles or trees.

Traffic Jam

The group is split into 2 equal subgroups. The 2 subgroups take their position facing each other with the empty space in the middle.

Starting formation: xxxxxx oooooo Finishing formation: oooooo xxxxxx

The purpose of the exercise is for the 2 groups to swap ends of the matrix without making any illegal moves.
Legal Moves:

1. A person can step forward to an empty space directly in front of them.
2. A person can move forward to an empty space passing only one player going in the opposite direction.
3. No person can move backwards

Tied-up

The group members stand very close together. A rope is put around them so that they are as close as possible. The task for the group is now to move themselves from one place to the another as fast as possible.
It is possible to have one group racing the other!

Eco-memory

You need some leaves, stones or little sticks which are placed on a blanket or t-shirt and covered with a second blanket (or t-shirt). The group is now told that the objects will be uncovered and that they will have two minutes to memorise as many as possible. After the two minutes the objects are recovered and the group must go and find as many similar objects as possible.

2x4

Eight members stand in a line, shoulder to shoulder with men and women alternating. The task will be successfully completed when on one side of the line there are only women and on the other only men.
The following rules will be applied:

- as few changes as possible
- all changes have to be in pairs (a pair: two people standing next to each other: man/woman, woman/woman, man/man.)
- when a pair changes, their space becomes free and can be filled by another pair.
- the pair can not change their order while they move around
- at the end, there are no free spaces allowed

The easiest solution is:

1.) m w m w m w m w

2.) m - - m w m w w m

3.) m m w w - - m w w m

4.) m m w w w w m - - m

Human Pyramid

Your group has to build a pyramid as quickly as possible. (e.g. 4-3-2-1)

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Sheep and Shepard

The group members have to invent an "acoustic" language (clapping, snapping fingers, etc– i.e., not talking), with which they are able to communicate direction and with which every member can be identified by their own " acoustic name".
All except the "Shepard" must then put on their blindfolds and all of the "sheep" are led away somewhere.
Using only with the acoustic language, the "Shepard" has to lead the "sheep" back into the sheep-pen.

Bridge

Two trees (or two other objects) about 8-10 metres away from each other are chosen. The group has to built a "bridge" over this distance by putting as few as possible feet, knees, hands, etc. on the ground.

Pipe

Inside the pipe there is a ping-pong ball that has to be removed without turning the pipe around. You can only use the material given.

Atomic bomb

The aim of this task is to get the bucket out of the circle by using only the equipment given. No member of the group is allowed to step into the circle. The bucket may not fall over. The group has 5 minutes to plan the task and 10 minutes to perform it.

Trash game

The team has to split into 4 different groups. The first group builds a figure with natural material. The second group may watch this figure and reports in detail to the third group how this figure looked like. The third group must then report their knowledge to the fourth group, which must rebuild the figure in detail.

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Others

Brainstorming Game

The committee is given the situation: A shoe company has somehow made 1000 left shoes. It, for some reason, cannot manufacture the right shoes. It wants to sell the left shoes, but doesn't know how. The committee is to solve the problem. The "rules" of brainstorming dictate that no idea be shot down, and that no ideas be discussed. They are simply written down by each delegate on post-it notes. After five minutes of brainstorming, stop.
The committee reports its results. Did people follow the rules? How were new ideas generated?

Equipment: Post-its, pens or pencils.

Jig Saw

As each delegate enters the room, give them a piece of a puzzle. (These should be simple puzzles with a relatively small number of pieces.) The delegates must cooperate with the other members to find out which puzzle they belong to and where their piece fits. This will help the participants work together to accomplish a task.

Equipment: A puzzle.

Warm Fuzzies

Cut squares of paper. Brainstorm a list of positive characteristics about other people (for example, kind, cheerful, considerate, fun, sincere, friendly, humorous, responsible, warm, empathic, loyal, unselfish). Invite participants to choose one positive characteristic from the list that best describes each person in the group. On one side of a square of paper, write the name of the person; on the other side, write a positive characteristic. When everyone is finished, hand the square to the person. Each person can place the squares in an envelope and enjoy their "warm fuzzies".

Equipment: Paper cut into squares (enough so each person has a square for each other person in the group), pen or pencil for each delegate and one envelope for each delegate

End of teambuilding

Hopes and fears

The committee sits in a circle and the chair asks every member to tell the others his/her hopes, expectations and fears for the week. The chair can take notes and come to make sure that he/she can take these hopes and fears into account during the week.

Help for the week

The committee sits in a circle and the chair asks every member to tell the others what he/she needs help with during the week and what kind of help he/she can offer. (What I can help you with.../ What you can help me with...)

Golden Rules

At the end of teambuilding you can come back to the debriefings you have done during the week with the team. Maybe you can set up golden rules in terms of behaviour for the week, so that you can assure through these rules a smooth running of committee work. It is the team which sets up these rules, NOT the chair. This makes it easier for the chair to use these rules.

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